P&C People Skills · Course 1 · Week 2

Look Beyond the Reaction

SLO

- 1.3 Interpret a reaction as a signal of an underlying need, fear or pressure, without taking it personally or jumping to conclusions

Models taught

- The Iceberg model of behaviour: the reaction is the tip; needs, fears and pressures sit below
- SCARF (David Rock, 2008): Status, Certainty, Autonomy, Relatedness, Fairness, taught as a practical lens rather than proven neuroscience
- In the moment: Pause → Probe → Pin → Respond

Situations walked through step by step

- Certainty: a new joiner snaps at you over a laptop delay ("Am I set up to succeed?")
- Status: a senior employee goes quiet after a restructure announcement (the issue is status, not the change)

20 spoken lines · 261 words · about 1.9 min + Taleemabad intro/outro · LearnFree-style visuals · voice spoken to "you"

#	Spoken line	On screen
01	When someone snaps at you, the reaction is rarely the real story. read: calmly, with a knowing warmth	Title card: **Beyond the Reaction**, *why people react the way they do*
02	Think of an iceberg: the reaction is only the small tip you can see. read: thoughtfully, painting a picture	Iceberg: tip The reaction
03	Below the waterline sit the needs, fears and beliefs that really drive it. read: slowly, with gentle insight	Iceberg: tip The reaction; below the waterline: Needs, Fears, Beliefs
04	A model called SCARF, from David Rock, helps you name what is underneath. read: clearly, introducing a useful tool	Model **SCARF**: S · C · A · R · F *(David Rock, 2008)*
05	It names five things people protect at work: status, certainty, autonomy, relatedness and fairness. read: steadily, one idea at a time	Model **SCARF**: S Status · C Certainty · A Autonomy · R Relatedness · F Fairness
06	Being sidelined hits status, uncertainty hits certainty, and being left out hits relatedness. read: with recognition, as if naming familiar moments	Model **SCARF**: **S Sidelined** · **C Uncertainty** · A · **R Left out** · F
07	When one feels threatened, we react as if under attack, and clear thinking drops. read: gently, with a note of caution	Iceberg: tip Snap · go quiet · push back; below the waterline: Threatened need (an alarm pulses on the tip)
08	So in the moment, you use four steps: pause, probe, pin and respond. read: confidently, giving a simple plan	Model **In the moment**: 1 Pause · 2 Probe · 3 Pin · 4 Respond
09	Say a new joiner snaps at you because their laptop still has not arrived. read: setting the scene, lightly	A person speaks: "Day three and still no laptop. Brilliant."
10	First, pause, and do not argue with the tip of the iceberg. read: calmly, steadying the moment	Model **In the moment**: **1 Pause** · 2 Probe · 3 Pin · 4 Respond
11	Then probe, gently: what worries you most about the delay? read: curious and kind	A person speaks: "What worries you most about the delay?"

#	Spoken line	On screen
12	They admit everyone else is working, and they worry they look useless. read: quietly, letting the real answer land	A person speaks: "Everyone is working. I look like I can't do the job."
13	Pin it: this is certainty, the question am I set up to succeed? read: with the satisfaction of a puzzle solved	Model **SCARF**: S · **C Certainty** · A · R · F · on screen: "Am I set up to succeed?"
14	So you respond to that need, with a firm date and a useful plan for today. read: warmly and practically	A person speaks: "It arrives Thursday. Today, you shadow the team lead."
15	Now a senior employee goes quiet after a restructure is announced. read: more seriously, raising the stakes	Iceberg: tip Goes quiet in meetings

⏸ CHECKPOINT: the video pauses here; the LMS asks; the learner must answer to continue. *(Not in the video.)*

Q: A senior employee has gone quiet since a restructure moved their team under a newer manager. What do you do first?

A. Explain the business reasons for the restructure to them again
B. Ask them privately how the change lands, and ask for their read on the new setup ✓
C. Leave it for now; they will adjust in a few weeks
D. Tell them in the team meeting that their role matters as much as ever

If right: Exactly. The quiet is the tip of the iceberg; underneath is status. Asking privately, and asking for their expert read, gives back the standing the change took away.

If wrong: The need underneath is status, so you respond to that: ask privately how it lands, and ask for their read on the new setup, which shows their experience still counts. Explaining the business reasons again answers certainty, not status, and can feel like a lecture. Leaving it lets the silence harden into disengagement. Reassuring them in the team meeting puts them on the spot in front of others, which can make the status threat worse, and it tells rather than shows.

17	Pin it: the change itself is not the issue; their status is. read: with clarity, naming the need	Model **SCARF**: **S Status** · C · A · R · F · on screen: "Where do I stand now?"
18	So you ask for their read privately, and give their experience a real role. read: warmly, with respect	A person speaks: "You know this team best. What would you change in the new setup?"
19	Understanding the need does not excuse the behaviour; you handle both, the need first. read: firmly but gently	Split: **Excuse ≠ Understand**
20	And keep SCARF as your private lens; never tell someone they have a status threat. read: as quiet, practical advice	Model **Your private lens**: S Status · C Certainty · A Autonomy · R Relatedness · F Fairness
21	So look below the waterline, name the need, and respond to that. read: warmly and with energy, a confident close	Recap cards: See the iceberg · Name the need with SCARF · Pause, probe, pin, respond

P&C People Skills · Course 1 · Week 3

Listen First, Then Ask

SLO

- 1.4 Demonstrate active listening: full attention, no interrupting, summarising and reflecting back
- 1.5 Use open, probing and clarifying questions, and avoid leading or blaming ones

Models taught

- RASA (Julian Treasure, TED 2011) for listening: Receive, Appreciate, Summarise, Ask
- OARS (Motivational Interviewing) for responding: Open questions, Affirmations, Reflections, Summaries
- The Question Funnel: Open → Probe → Close

Situations walked through step by step

- Quick chat: "Can we have a quick chat?" about a travel form; the real issue (three months of late claims) surfaces after three questions
- Leading vs open: the same exit interview run twice, once with leading questions and once with OARS

22 spoken lines · 298 words · about 2.2 min + Taleemabad intro/outro · LearnFree-style visuals · voice spoken to "you"

#	Spoken line	On screen
01	The fastest way to the real problem is to listen before you ask. read: calmly, with quiet confidence	Title card: **Listen First**, *then ask*
02	When someone asks for a quick chat, the first thing they say is rarely everything. read: knowingly, with a small smile	Iceberg: tip "Can we have a quick chat?"; below the waterline: The real issue
03	Our instinct is to fix things fast, and that is exactly what stops them talking. read: honestly, admitting a common habit	Split: **Fix fast ≠ Listen first**
04	For listening, Julian Treasure's RASA gives you four steps: receive, appreciate, summarise, ask. read: clearly, introducing a simple tool	Model **RASA**: R Receive · A Appreciate · S Summarise · A Ask *(Julian Treasure, 2011)*
05	Receive: put your phone face down, turn towards them, and simply take it in. read: gently and slowly	Model **RASA**: **R Receive** · A Appreciate · S Summarise · A Ask · on screen: Phone down. Face them.
06	Appreciate: small sounds like "hmm" and "go on" show you are with them. read: warmly, almost conversational	Model **RASA**: R Receive · **A Appreciate** · S Summarise · A Ask · on screen: "Hmm... go on."
07	Summarise: start with "so", and say back what you heard. read: with gentle emphasis on the word so	Model **RASA**: R Receive · A Appreciate · **S Summarise** · A Ask · on screen: "So what I'm hearing is..."
08	Ask comes last, and the question funnel tells you the order. read: clearly, setting up the next idea	Model **RASA**: R Receive · A Appreciate · S Summarise · **A Ask** · on screen: Questions come last.
09	Start open, then probe what came up, then close to confirm. read: steadily, one step at a time	Question funnel: Open → Probe → Close
10	Say a field coordinator stops you at the chai station about a confusing travel form. read: lightly, setting an everyday scene	A person speaks: "This new travel form is so confusing."
11	The fixer explains section B in thirty seconds, and the conversation ends there. read: with a wry note, showing the trap	Split screen: **The fixer** "Easy, just fill section B!" | **The listener** (focus: left)
12	Instead you receive and appreciate, and they add that their claims are three months late.	A person speaks: "It's not just the form. My claims are three months late."

#	Spoken line	On screen
	read: softly, letting the truth come out	
13	You summarise: "So it is not only the form, it is the late payments." read: warmly, with understanding	A person speaks: "So it's not only the form. It's the late payments?"
14	Then you funnel: what happened, which months, and shall I chase Finance by Thursday? read: practically, with momentum	Question funnel: Open "What's been happening with your claims?" → Probe "Which months are pending?" → Close "Shall I check with Finance by Thursday?"

⏸ **CHECKPOINT**: the video pauses here; the LMS asks; the learner must answer to continue. *(Not in the video.)*

Q: A content designer is leaving after two years. In the exit interview, which question will teach you the most?

A. You're leaving for a better salary, right?
B. What made you start looking? ✓
C. Why didn't you raise this with us earlier?
D. The team was supportive though, wasn't it?

If right: Exactly. It is open, so they choose what matters, and it carries no assumption, so you hear the real reason instead of the one you expected.

If wrong: "What made you start looking?" is open, so the person decides what matters and you hear the real reason. "You're leaving for a better salary, right?" and "The team was supportive, wasn't it?" are leading questions: they hand over the answer you expect, so you mostly get a polite yes and learn nothing. "Why didn't you raise this earlier?" sounds like blame, so people get defensive and say less. If you need the why, ask "what led you to..." instead.

16	For your replies, OARS from Motivational Interviewing gives four moves: open questions, affirmations, reflections and summaries. read: clearly, introducing the second tool	Model **OARS**: O Open questions · A Affirm · R Reflect · S Summarise *(Motivational Interviewing)*
17	Run an exit interview with leading questions, and you only get the yes you expected. read: with gentle irony	Split screen: **Leading** "You're leaving for a better salary, right?" | **OARS** (focus: left)
18	Run it again with OARS, starting with an open question: what made you start looking? read: warmly, starting again	Model **OARS**: **O Open questions** · A Affirm · R Reflect · S Summarise · on screen: "What made you start looking?"
19	Now you get the truth: they stopped growing after their lead left. read: sincerely, as the honest answer arrives	A person speaks: "Honestly, I stopped growing after my lead left."
20	Affirm their honesty, then reflect it back: so growth mattered more than pay. read: warmly and thoughtfully	Model **OARS**: O Open questions · **A Affirm** · **R Reflect** · S Summarise · on screen: "Thank you for being honest. So growth mattered more than pay."
21	Summarise what you heard, then ask what would have made them stay. read: steadily, bringing it together	Model **OARS**: O Open questions · A Affirm · R Reflect · **S Summarise** · on screen: "So: growth, a new lead, no plan. What would have made you stay?"
22	And swap "why did you" for "what led you to", so it never sounds like blame. read: as a helpful tip	Split screen: **Sounds like blame** "Why did you do that?" | **Sounds curious** "What led you to that?" (focus: right)

#	Spoken line	On screen
23	So listen with RASA, ask from open to closed, and reply with OARS. read: warmly and with energy, a confident close	Recap cards: Listen with RASA · Open → Probe → Close · Reply with OARS

P&C People Skills · Course 1 · Week 4

Warm but Fair

SLO

- 1.6 Respond with empathy while staying objective, separating facts, feelings and assumptions, across journey moments

Models taught

- Empathy vs sympathy (Brené Brown, after Theresa Wiseman): "at least…" is the sympathy tell
- Ladder of Inference (Chris Argyris): What happened → What it means → Conclusion → Action, and how to climb back down
- GROW (Alexander, Fine & Whitmore): Goal, Reality, Options, Way forward

Situations walked through step by step

- "The new hire is always late and doesn't care" → climbing down to the facts (Mondays, a new van route)
- An employee whose parent is in hospital → GROW, without promising what you don't control

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#	Spoken line	On screen
01	You can be warm with someone and still be completely fair. read: calmly, with warm conviction	Title card: **Warm but Fair**, *empathy that stays objective*
02	Empathy means understanding their feeling; it does not mean agreeing with their version of events. read: clearly, drawing an important line	Split: **Agree ≠ Understand**
03	Sympathy says "at least"; empathy says "that sounds really heavy". read: gently, contrasting two replies	Split screen: **Sympathy** "At least it's not serious." | **Empathy** "That sounds really heavy." (focus: right)
04	To stay fair, use the Ladder of Inference, from Chris Argyris. read: introducing a useful tool, with curiosity	Ladder: What happened → What it means → Conclusion → Action
05	We climb from what happened, to what it means, to a conclusion, to action, in seconds. read: a little faster, showing how quickly it happens	Ladder: What happened → What it means → Conclusion → Action (climbs up fast)
06	Say a team lead tells you a new hire is always late and does not care. read: setting the scene, matter-of-factly	A person speaks: "The new hire is always late. They just don't care."
07	"Does not care" is the top of the ladder, not the bottom. read: thoughtfully, with a gentle pause	Ladder: What happened → What it means → **Conclusion** → Action · label: "Doesn't care"
08	So you climb down, and ask which days, and what times exactly. read: calmly and curiously	A person speaks: "Which days, and what times exactly?"
09	The facts: late three times in two weeks, all Mondays, about twenty minutes. read: precisely, letting the facts speak	Ladder: **What happened** → What it means → Conclusion → Action · label: 3 times in 2 weeks · all Mondays · ~20 min
10	You ask the new hire openly, and learn their new van route runs late on Mondays. read: warmly, with a small turn of discovery	A person speaks: "My new van route from Rawalpindi runs late on Mondays."
11	Same facts, a very different story, and nobody was judged before being heard. read: with quiet satisfaction	Balance scale: The team lead ⚖ The new hire
12	When someone is struggling, the GROW model helps you support them without rescuing. read: introducing a tool, with care	Model **GROW**: G Goal · R Reality · O Options · W Way forward *(Whitmore, 1992)*

#	Spoken line	On screen
13	Say an employee's parent is in hospital, and their deadlines are slipping. read: softly, with real empathy	A person speaks: "My father is in hospital in Lahore. I keep missing deadlines."

⏸ **CHECKPOINT**: the video pauses here; the LMS asks; the learner must answer to continue. *(Not in the video.)*

Q: An employee whose parent is in hospital asks you to guarantee them two weeks off. What do you say?

A. "Done. I'll make sure you get the two weeks."
B. "Leave isn't my department, you'll need to ask your manager."
C. "Let's look at the options together, and I'll help you ask your manager today." ✓
D. "At least it's only two weeks you need."

If right: Exactly. You stay warm and on their side of the problem, while being honest that the decision sits with their manager. Helping them ask today is support you can actually deliver.

If wrong: The fair and warm answer is to explore the options together and help them ask their manager today. Promising the two weeks feels kind, but leave is the manager's decision, so it is a promise you may not be able to keep, and it is unfair to others who follow the process. Sending them off to their manager is accurate but cold: it leaves them alone at a hard moment. "At least..." is sympathy, not empathy; it shrinks what they are going through.

15	The tempting reply is a promise, but leave is their manager's decision, not yours. read: gently, naming a kind mistake	Split screen: **The promise** "Don't worry, I'll get you two weeks off." | **The support** "That sounds really heavy. Let's work out what would help." (focus: right)
16	Goal: you ask what matters most to them this month. read: warmly and slowly	Model **GROW**: **G Goal** · R Reality · O Options · W Way forward · on screen: "What matters most to you this month?"
17	Reality: what is already in place at work, and what have they tried? read: steadily	Model **GROW**: G Goal · **R Reality** · O Options · W Way forward · on screen: "What's already in place? What have you tried?"
18	Options: compassionate leave, a short spell of working from home, or a moved deadline. read: with gentle encouragement	Options branch out: Compassionate leave · Work from home · Move a deadline (they choose one)
19	Way forward: "Shall we draft the message to your manager together, today?" read: warmly and practically, with lift	Model **GROW**: G Goal · R Reality · O Options · **W Way forward** · on screen: "Shall we draft it together, today?"
20	Warm in your tone, fair in your process: that is the whole balance. read: with calm conviction	Balance scale: Warm in tone ⚖ Fair in process
21	So show empathy, climb down to the facts, and use GROW instead of promises. read: warmly and with energy, a confident close	Recap cards: Empathy, not "at least" · Climb down to the facts · GROW, not promises